# Sanaul Haque

## Eaint_Ngone_Phoo_Proposal

Assignment 108

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# IARCO RESEARCH PROPOSAL

**Full Legal Name:** Eaint Ngone Phoo

**Institution:** Institute of International Professionalism

**Category:** Junior

**Class/Grade/Year:** O Level

**Country:** Myanmar

**Submission Date:** September 20, 2026

**Registered Email Address:** eaintngonep@gmail.com

**Research Topic:** Economic Impact of Disaster Strikes: Enhancing Economic Rehabilitation in Impoverished Regions of Myanmar

## Introduction

Myanmar is highly vulnerable to disasters as it experiences heavy rainfall mostly during the monsoon season, as well as various disasters, for example landslides, cyclones, Typhoons, earthquakes, and more [2]. Such catastrophes are mainly due to the geographical location of the country. Moreover, it can detrimentally impact the livelihood of the local residents in rural part of Myanmar as people rely heavily on primary sector for example, the agricultural work which is their source of income and most crops were destroyed by destructive floodings (WorldBank,2025) [1]. As a result, it led to people becoming impoverished as they no longer have a subsistence; therefore, businesses fail to operate, aggregate demand for the whole economy decreases, and it ultimately results in declining GDP, including infrastructure damage. The economic loss of a recent disaster that occurred in 2025 march 7.7 magnitude results in estimated US$11billion loss [1]. This study aims to investigate how to prevent people from losing their businesses and assets due to disasters, which could potentially help the country's economy not be affected by the calamity.

## Research Questions

1. How have the devastating disasters impacted people economically?
2. In what ways can the Burmese government and financial institutions aid in minimising the number of economic losses?
3. Which factors have worsened the economic crisis after disasters?

## Literature Review:

Developed countries like Japan have proactive measures to prevent the most common natural hazards, such as heavy rain, from harming the economy. This is done by financial institutions investing in flood control systems to lower the loss of infrastructure damage losses, which is also an innovative way to reduce the cost of insurance settlements. In contrast, Myanmar as it is one of the Low-and-Middle-Income countries (LMICs) and it does not have an effective mitigation system, although it has an established legal and institutional framework [3]. The issue is the ongoing conflict, which has fractured the ties between state entities and these local partners and has broken ties with CBOs [5]. Moreover, Myanmar is extremely vulnerable to disasters and has fewer precautionary measures than other countries, resulting in tremendous damage [4]. A recent study stated that heritage sites as well as many pagodas in Mandalay and Sagaing have been destroyed by the earthquake that occurred in April 2025 [1]. Ultimately leading to a dramatic decrease in tourism, impacting the tourism sector with lower revenue being generated; consequently, SMEs lack the financial buffers to survive prolonged drops in consumer demand. Localised disasters quickly translate into widespread economic hardship. Furthermore, MSPS results indicate that Myanmar’s poverty rate remained at 31.0 per cent in 2024, which is high compared with the 2017 poverty rate, which was an official estimate of 24.8 per cent [1]. The aim of this study is to enhance economic rehabilitation by introducing low-interest recovery loans or temporary credit guarantees for affected SMEs. Disasters also affect the macroeconomy as well as having socioeconomic consequences [6]. In addition, the lack of social protection towards disasters has worsened the economy as locals were left with nothing after a catastrophe [7]

**Methodology:**

This research will adopt a mixed-method approach to conduct the research which uses both quantitative and qualitative methods to identify the issues that locals faced after a disaster strikes. In addition, the data collected will be utilised to compare the income before being affected by the disasters with the income after being affected for the same person. An appropriate set of questionnaires will be prepared, and volunteers who want to participate on collecting data will be trained conscientiously before the investigation begins. The information collected from villagers will be used for research purposes only and will remain strictly anonymous and confidential to ensure the safety and privacy of the locals. Ethical approval will be obtained from the relevant local government authorities to ensure the research complies with ethical standards and regulations. A Qualitative method will be conducted with key informants and selected community members using semi-structured interviews and focus group discussions. This phase will primarily focus on capturing people's emotional distress that the quantitative method is unable to express. This method includes using open-ended conversations, allowing the researchers to understand different viewpoints and personal insights. On the other hand, the quantitative method will be utilised to gather structured, numerical data from a larger sample size of the affected population in addition to using a Paired-sample t-test to measure the damage caused before and after.

**Project Timeline:**

*Week 1: Settling research question, gathering volunteers, finding related information with secondary resources*

*Week 2: Preparing questionnaires and training participants for interviewing and collecting data*

*Week 3: Conducting the research in 4 villages with volunteers*

*Week 4: Writing a research paper to submit to the government in order to access a lower interest rate for affected areas, which will be funded by government financial institutions.*

**Roadblocks and Potential Limitations:**

This study mainly focuses on areas that are mostly affected by the disaster in Ayeyarwady region. Specifically, Pyapon, Bogale, Labutta and Ngapudaw villages. Therefore, people from other parts of Myanmar will not be included to share their experiences and losses.

**Conclusion:**

In conclusion, this study aims to enhance the livelihood of Myanmar citizens by providing low-interest recovery loans for affected areas in order to reduce the economic losses caused by natural hazards; therefore, people can enjoy a better quality of life and minimal disruptions to local residents. Overall, the proposed research is expected to contribute to the country's economy and well-being.

Reference

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